

THE FOURTH TRIMESTER

A Postpartum Wellness Journal
for New Moms

You are doing amazing.
Even on the hard days.
Especially on the hard days.

Daniel Tesfamariam

THE FOURTH TRIMESTER

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If you are in crisis: PSI Helpline 1-800-944-4773

Text HOME to 741741 | In emergency call 911

WHAT TO EXPECT IN THE 4TH TRIMESTER

The first 12 weeks after birth are a massive transition. You may feel:

- Overwhelming love AND overwhelm
- Joy AND grief for your old life
- Touched out AND lonely
- Grateful AND resentful
- Like a superhero AND like you're failing
- Bonded AND disconnected
- All of these in one hour

ALL of this is normal. You are not failing. You are BECOMING.

Baby's name: _____ Born: _____

Birth story (in one line): _____

POSTPARTUM MOOD CHECK

Edinburgh Postnatal Depression Scale (self-screen):

In the past 7 days... (0=not at all, 3=most of the time)

- | | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|---|
| 1. I have been able to laugh and see the funny side | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| 2. I have looked forward to things with enjoyment | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| 3. I have blamed myself unnecessarily when things went wrong | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| 4. I have been anxious or worried for no good reason | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| 5. I have felt scared or panicky for no good reason | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| 6. Things have been getting on top of me | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| 7. I have been so unhappy that I have difficulty sleeping | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| 8. I have felt sad or miserable | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| 9. I have been so unhappy that I have been crying | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| 10. The thought of harming myself has occurred to me | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 |

Score: ____ (10+ = talk to your provider. 13+ = seek help now)

This is NOT diagnosis. It's a prompt to seek support if needed.

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 1

Day 1 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 2 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 2

Day 3 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 4 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 3

Day 5 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 6 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 4

Day 7 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 8 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 5

Day 9 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 10 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 6

Day 11 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 12 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 7

Day 13 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 14 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 8

Day 15 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 16 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 9

Day 17 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 18 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 10

Day 19 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 20 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 11

Day 21 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 22 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 12

Day 23 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 24 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 13

Day 25 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 26 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 14

Day 27 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 28 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 15

Day 29 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 30 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 16

Day 31 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 32 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 17

Day 33 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 34 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 18

Day 35 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 36 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 19

Day 37 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 38 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 20

Day 39 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 40 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 21

Day 41 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 42 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 22

Day 43 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 44 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 23

Day 45 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 46 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 24

Day 47 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 48 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 25

Day 49 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 50 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 26

Day 51 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 52 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 27

Day 53 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 54 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 28

Day 55 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 56 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 29

Day 57 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 58 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

DAILY JOURNAL - Page 30

Day 59 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

Day 60 Date: _____

Hours slept (total, inc naps): ____ Mood (1-10): ____

Baby feeding: []Breast []Bottle []Both Approx feeds: ____

My meals today: B _____ L _____ D _____ Snacks: ____

One thing I did for MYSELF: _____

Help I accepted today: _____

Worry I'm carrying: _____

One beautiful moment: _____

POSTPARTUM BODY HEALING TIMELINE

Week 1-2:

Bleeding (lochia), cramping, breast engorgement, exhaustion

Week 3-4:

Bleeding tapering, stitches healing, emotions stabilizing (or not)

Week 5-6:

6-week checkup, cleared for exercise (gentle!), may still be tired

Month 2-3:

Hormone shifts, hair may start falling out (normal!), finding rhythm

Month 4-6:

Body still recovering. Give yourself GRACE. 9 months on, 9+ months off.

Remember: Your body grew a human. It deserves patience, not punishment.

BREASTFEEDING SUPPORT RESOURCES

Whether you breastfeed, pump, formula feed, or combo - you're a **good mom. Fed is best. YOUR mental health matters too.**

My lactation consultant: _____ Phone: _____

La Leche League: lila.org

KellyMom: kellymom.com (evidence-based BF info)

Breastfeeding hotline: 1-800-994-9662

Challenges I'm having: _____

Permission slip: It's okay to stop. It's okay to supplement.

Your value as a mother is NOT measured in ounces.

ASKING FOR HELP: 5 SCRIPTS

To a partner:

'I need you to take the baby for ____ hours so I can ____.'

To family:

'Could you come over Tuesday? I need help with ____ / just company.'

To a friend:

'I'm struggling today. Can you [bring food/visit/just listen]?'

To a professional:

'I don't feel like myself. I think I need support.'

To yourself:

'I am allowed to need help. Asking doesn't make me weak.'

Accepting help is NOT failure. It takes a village.

You don't get extra points for doing it alone.

PARTNER COMMUNICATION

What I need from my partner right now:

What I appreciate about my partner:

Division of labor that works for us:

Night feeds: _____

Diaper duty: _____

Household: _____

Emotional support: _____

WHEN TO CALL YOUR DOCTOR

Warning signs (call immediately):

- Fever over 100.4F
- Heavy bleeding (soaking pad in 1 hr)
- Foul-smelling discharge
- Severe headache or vision changes
- Pain/redness in legs (blood clot)
- Thoughts of harming yourself or baby
- Chest pain or difficulty breathing
- Unable to care for yourself or baby

MY VILLAGE (who helps with what):

Meals: _____

Cleaning: _____

Older kids: _____

Errands: _____

Emotional support: _____

Night help: _____

6-WEEK RECOVERY MILESTONES

- ☐ Survived the first night home
- ☐ Baby regained birth weight
- ☐ Went outside (even to mailbox)
- ☐ Took a shower without rushing
- ☐ Slept 3+ hours in a row
- ☐ Asked for and accepted help
- ☐ Had a moment of pure joy
- ☐ Made it to 6-week checkup
- ☐ Went somewhere alone (without baby)

YOU ARE DOING AMAZING

The fact that you worry about being a good mom
means you already ARE one.